

Band 7–9 Vocabulary

Module 2 Extension: Precise vocabulary for data description

Synonyms for Increase

escalate, ascend, climb, surge, soar, rocket, burgeon, proliferate, multiply, accumulate, augment, amplify, intensify, mount, swell, accelerate, expedite, snowball, mushroom, balloon

Synonyms for Decrease

plummet, plunge, slump, nosedive, dwindle, taper, wane, ebb, recede, diminish, abate, contract, curtail, erode, shrink, whittle, deplete, attenuate

Stability and Change

stabilise, plateau, level off, stagnate, remain buoyant, hover around, fluctuate, oscillate, vacillate, undulate, rebound, recover, revert, regress, progress, advance, proliferate

Multi-line Comparison

overtake, be overtaken by, outstrip, outpace, eclipse, dwarf, lag behind, trail, converge, diverge, diverge sharply, mirror, parallel, align with, inverse relationship, correlation, parity

Precision Language for Magnitude

negligible, marginal, incremental, substantial, considerable, pronounced, dramatic, precipitous, meteoric, exponential, linear, gradual, progressive, incremental, sporadic, erratic

Near-Synonyms: The Subtle Differences

Understanding what makes each word unique

Surge vs Soar

Surge: sudden and temporary increase. **Soar:** sustained upward movement over time. "Profits surged briefly" vs "Profits soared throughout the year."

Plummet vs Plunge

Plummet: steeper, more dramatic fall. **Plunge:** sharp but slightly less extreme. "Stocks plummeted 40%" sounds sharper than "plunged."

Escalate vs Accelerate

Escalate: intensify or worsen, often in conflict. **Accelerate:** speed up, increase pace. "Tensions escalated" vs "Growth accelerated."

Proliferate vs Accumulate

Proliferate: rapid reproduction, increase in variety/numbers. **Accumulate:** gathering more of the same thing. "Species proliferated" vs "Debt accumulated."

Stagnate vs Plateau

Stagnate: suggests stuck, dead, negative. **Plateau:** natural levelling off after growth, neutral/positive. "Growth stagnated" sounds like bad news; "levelled at 5%" is factual.

Erode vs Diminish

Erode: gradual wearing away over time. **Diminish:** quicker, broader loss. "Trust eroded slowly" vs "Revenue diminished sharply."

The band 8-9 skill is knowing not just the word, but when to use it.